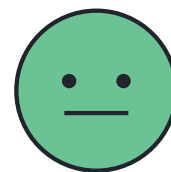
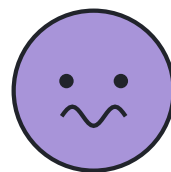
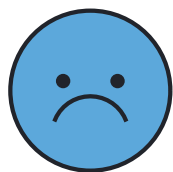




TEEN WELLBEING SEL SERIES



Quiet the Noise

Mindfulness & Calm - A Practical Workbook for Teens

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-19 - Printable

Home - Classroom - Counseling - Calm Corners

Reproducible for one home or classroom



How to Use This Book

This workbook is made for ages 10 to 19 - a stage packed with change, pressure, and big emotions. It won't talk down to you. Instead, it gives you real tools, honest questions, and space to think for yourself.

There are no grades and no wrong answers. Work at your own pace, be honest in the writing spaces, and come back to the pages that help most. Skills grow with practice.

For Grown-Ups

- ☐ Give privacy - journaling is more honest when it isn't graded or read without permission.
- ☐ Offer to talk, but don't force it; being available matters more than pushing.
- ☐ Model the skills yourself - teens notice what adults actually do.
- ☐ If big feelings feel unmanageable, connect the teen with a counselor or trusted professional.

Tip: There are no wrong answers here. Every feeling is okay. What matters is what we choose to DO with big feelings.



How This Book Works

Each part mixes three things: short explanations of what's going on in your brain and body, self-checks to notice your own patterns, and tools plus reflection to help you respond in ways you feel good about.

Getting the most from it

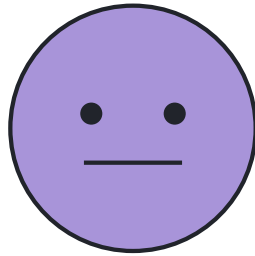
- ☐ Be honest - this is for you, not for show.
- ☐ Try the tools more than once before deciding if they help.
- ☐ Use the trackers to spot patterns over a week or two.
- ☐ Revisit the plans and update them as you learn.

This activity book supports everyday social-emotional learning and self-reflection. It is not therapy or medical advice. If you are struggling with your safety or mental health, please talk to a trusted adult, a counselor, or a local helpline right away.

What's Inside



- 1 What Mindfulness Is
- 2 Noticing My Mind
- 3 Breathing & Grounding
- 4 Everyday Mindfulness
- 5 Real-Life Scenarios
- 6 Reflection & Plan



Part 1: What Mindfulness Is

Paying attention, on purpose, without judging.



Mindfulness Isn't Emptying Your Mind

Mindfulness doesn't mean stopping your thoughts or 'feeling zen' all the time. It means noticing what's happening right now - your breath, your body, your thoughts - without grabbing onto it or judging it.

Your mind will wander a thousand times; that's not failing. The practice is simply noticing you've wandered and gently coming back. Over time it calms the mental noise.

Why bother?

- ☐ It lowers stress and helps you focus.
- ☐ It creates a pause between feeling and reacting.
- ☐ It helps you actually enjoy good moments.
- ☐ It improves sleep and mood over time.

The Busy Mind

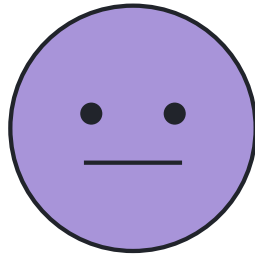


Our minds love to time-travel: replaying the past (regret) or racing to the future (worry). Very little stress lives in the actual present moment. Mindfulness gently brings you back to now, where you can breathe and choose.

You don't need incense or an hour of silence. A single mindful minute counts.

Coming back to now

- ☐ Feel your feet on the floor.
- ☐ Take three slow, noticed breaths.
- ☐ Name what you're doing right now.



Part 2: Noticing My Mind

Watch your thoughts like clouds.



My Mind & Attention Check

Rate how true each has been lately.

1 = Rarely 5 = Very often

My mind races or won't switch off.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I get lost in worry about the future.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I replay the past a lot.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I find it hard to focus on one thing.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I miss the good moment because I'm distracted.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I struggle to relax or fall asleep.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

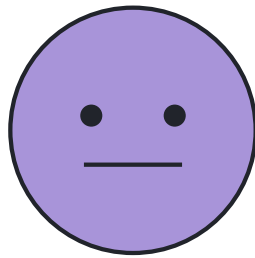
What my answers tell me



What's on My Mind

Do a 'brain dump': write whatever thoughts are buzzing right now.

Which of these can you set down for now, and which need action?



Part 3: Breathing & Grounding

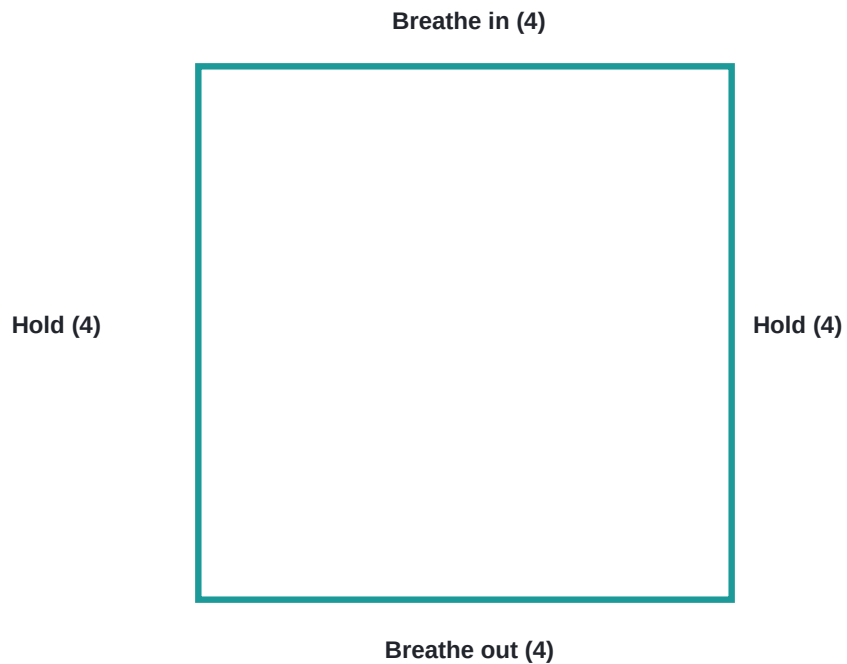
Simple practices you can do anywhere.



Box Breathing

Slow breathing tells our body it is safe. Trace the shape slowly with your finger while you breathe. Do it 3-5 times.

Box Breathing



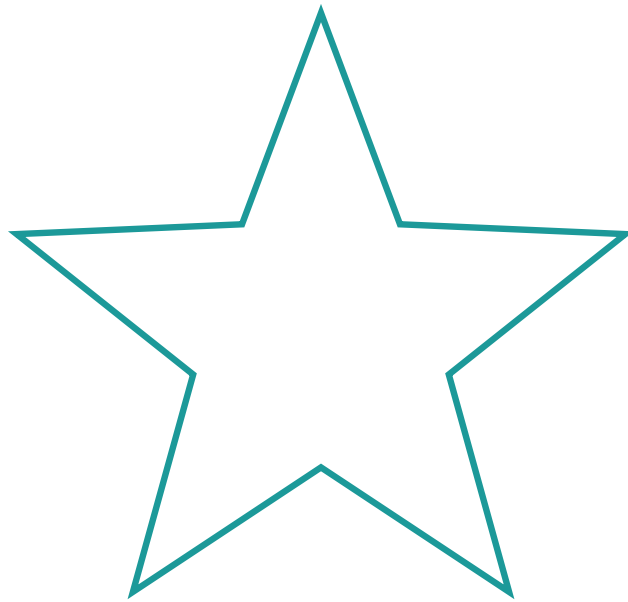
1. Breathe in for 4 (trace up).
2. Hold for 4 (across).
3. Out for 4 (down).
4. Hold for 4 (across).
5. Repeat 4-6 times.



Finger Breathing

Slow breathing tells our body it is safe. Trace the shape slowly with your finger while you breathe. Do it 3-5 times.

Five-Finger Breathing



1. Trace up a finger as you breathe in.
2. Trace down as you breathe out.
3. Move across all five fingers slowly.
4. Notice how your body feels after.



The 5 Senses Reset

A quick way to drop into the present. Fill it in now, then use it anytime you feel scattered.

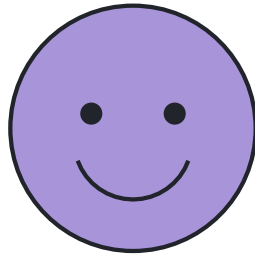
5 things I can SEE

4 things I can HEAR

3 things I can FEEL

2 things I can SMELL

1 thing I'm grateful for right now



Part 4: Everyday Mindfulness

Bring calm into ordinary moments.

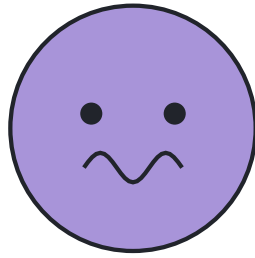


Mindfulness in Daily Life

You don't need extra time - just attention. Tick the mini-practices you'll try.

- ☐ Eat one meal slowly, actually tasting it.
- ☐ Take three mindful breaths before school or bed.
- ☐ Notice five things on a walk you usually ignore.
- ☐ Listen to a song with full attention.
- ☐ Feel the water and warmth while you shower.
- ☐ Put the phone down and just be, for one minute.

The mini-practice I'll build into my day



Part 5: Real-Life Scenarios

Use calm when you need it.



Calm Situations (1)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

1 Your mind won't stop racing at bedtime.

What could you do?

2 You feel panicky before a test or performance.

What could you do?

3 You're so distracted you can't get started.

What could you do?



Calm Situations (2)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

- 1** You're overwhelmed and everything feels like too much.

What could you do?

- 2** You keep replaying an embarrassing moment.

What could you do?

- 3** You feel wound-up and can't relax.

What could you do?



My Calm Practice Plan

Make mindfulness a small daily habit.

When I'll practice (a time that fits my day):

My go-to breathing or grounding tool:

A mindful moment I'll add to daily life:

How I'll come back when my mind wanders:

My Personal Wellbeing Plan



Pull it all together. This is your go-to plan when things get hard.

My early warning signs that a feeling is getting big:

My top 3 tools that actually work for me:

People I can reach out to (and how):

Kind, true things I can tell myself:

One habit that helps me feel steady:



When You Need More Help

Some feelings are too big to handle alone - and that's not weakness, it's human. Reaching out is a strong, smart move.

Reach out if...

- ☐ A feeling won't ease up for days, or keeps getting worse.
- ☐ You're avoiding things you used to enjoy.
- ☐ You have thoughts of hurting yourself or others.
- ☐ You just need someone to talk to - that's reason enough.

Who I can reach out to

If you ever feel unsafe or think about hurting yourself, tell a trusted adult now or contact a local emergency number or crisis/helpline in your country right away. You deserve support.



What Matters to Me

Knowing what matters to you makes decisions and hard days easier. When you act in line with your values, stress often makes more sense and feels more manageable.

Three values that matter most to me

One goal that fits those values

One small step I can take this week



Checking In With Myself

What's one thing I'm handling better than I used to?

What still feels hard, and what might help?



Saying It: Boundary Scripts

A boundary is a limit that protects your wellbeing. Boundaries can be kind AND firm. Practice wording so it's ready when you need it.

Saying no without over-explaining: "No thanks, that doesn't work for me." My version:

Asking for space: "I need some time to myself right now." My version:

Naming a limit online: "Please don't share that." My version:

Asking for what I need: "It would help me if..." My version:



A Letter to Future Me

Write a short letter to yourself six months from now.

What do you hope is different? What do you want to remember?



Good Things Worth Noticing

Noticing good things helps calm our minds and lift our mood. It doesn't erase hard feelings, but it reminds us that good things are here too.

Three good things about today

Someone I'm thankful for - and why

Draw something that makes you smile:

My Notes & Reflections



A series of horizontal lines for writing notes and reflections.



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Lined area for writing notes and reflections.



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